



Buying Tips

- ✓ **BATTERY:** The uptime for most Lithium-ion battery powered laptops is about three to four hours. Purchase a spare battery in case you happen to use your notebook for a period longer than that while travelling.
- ✓ **KEYBOARD:** In case you do a lot of typing, a larger keyboard is what you need to look for. Having the eight cursor-control keys is very important. Using the proper interface, any regular PC keyboard can be connected to your notebook.
- ✓ **DRIVES OR BAYS:** Though it makes sense to have all drives such as the floppy drive and the DVD/CD-ROM drive built into the main casing, a hot-swappable bay gives you greater flexibility.
- ✓ **DOCKING STATIONS:** This is useful if you are using your notebook as a desktop replacement. However, not all notebook models give you this option.
- ✓ **COMMUNICATION:** Look for a 56 Kbps modem PCMCIA card with an RJ-45 connector if you do not have an inbuilt modem. If you need to connect to a network, you will also need an inbuilt, or a PCMCIA-based, Ethernet port.
- ✓ **POINTING DEVICE:** You can choose between a pointing stick or a touch pad. Pointers are easier to control, but can give you a sore finger, especially when it's used at a stretch.
- ✓ **USB LIGHT:** Purchase a USB light that illuminates the notebook's keyboard, in case you carry it along on long haul flights. This eliminates the need of an overhead light.
- ✓ **CARRY CASE:** A sturdy carry case is essential for a laptop PC. These are available in various types and sizes. Some also serve as overnight travel bags.
- ✓ **NOTEBOOK LOCKS:** Opt for a Kensington lock to secure your notebook to a fixed item such as furniture. Verify whether your notebook has the necessary provision to use one.



- ① **External Keyboard/Mouse:** If you wish to use a laptop as a desktop replacement, you can attach an external keyboard or mouse as these provide more comfort than those inbuilt.
- ② **External Speakers:** If the low volume of the inbuilt speakers of a laptop gets you down, you can attach a set of external speakers.
- ③ **Portable Printer:** A variety of portable printers can be carried along to print on the go.



Do Remember

- Check the features and specifications of the accessories before you purchase them. Some newer accessories have issues with older laptops.
- As far as possible, opt for branded accessories since they normally come with a replacement or repair warranty. Assembled or locally made accessories may not have this option, and are usually of poor quality.

The Future

The segment of laptop accessories is very dynamic, with newer and better add-ons becoming available everyday. Accessories such as portable printers and projectors have just begun to appear. Although these have not yet become quite the craze, the convenience that such accessories offer has slowly begun to dawn upon laptop users. Expect this market to see a number of such laptop peripherals in the years to come.

Quick Find	
YOU NEED	A travelling PC
Basic Use	
LOOK FOR	Batteries that will provide you with all the power you need
YOU NEED	Accessories for your laptop to make business presentations
Inter Use	
LOOK FOR	A wireless remote pointing device
YOU NEED	A laptop that acts as a desktop replacement
Prof Use	
LOOK FOR	A docking station and an external keyboard and mouse